

ACTIVITY 18 — FACILITATOR GUIDE**Communication Plan, Channels and Status Reporting**

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Workshop	75 minutes	LO4	4 - Lead the Project Team

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to compute communication channels with $N(N-1)/2$ and derive the management implication of superlinear growth.

What learners produce

communication plan, status reports — submitted to artifacts/.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- The Project Management Templates pack (see the Activities folder)
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- The course slides for the framework and worked example

Set-up

Groups of 3 to 4. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group; each group needs one laptop for the calculations.

Scenario / briefing material

Contoso Learning Pte Ltd is a training provider with 14,000 active learners. Its course registration portal is 9 years old. Registration takes a median of 11 minutes and 34% of attempts are abandoned. Learner communications consume 24 staff-hours per week across 3 administrators. 62% of learner traffic is mobile, against a portal that is not responsive. Legacy consent screens do not meet current PDPA requirements. The project modernises course registration and learner communications.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Compute the communication channels. The last row is the number that should change your behaviour. There are 153 potential channels across the stakeholder set. Nobody can service 153 channels. A communication plan is not administrative tidiness; it is the decision about which of the 153 you will actually maintain and at what frequency.	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.
2	Choose push, pull or interactive for each stakeholder	If the room agrees too quickly, take the quietest role aside and give them one more constraint.
3	Place communications in the formal/informal by written/verbal grid	Debrief on what was conceded and why — the trade, not the outcome, is the learning.

4	Build the communication plan with feedback loops. The ECO People T8 enabler is "establish a feedback loop". A row with no feedback mechanism is a broadcast, and a broadcast tells you nothing about whether the message arrived. Complete every column.	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.
5	Trace the communication model and name the noise	Make a group state the UNITS and the base date. Most errors here are unit errors, not maths errors.
6	The week-14 status data. Create artifacts/18-status-reports.md. One set of facts follows. All three reports in Step 7 must be traceable to it. Tailoring means changing the encoding for the audience; it does not mean changing the numbers.	Ask what the number would have to be before the decision flips. That is the exam's favourite question.
7	Write the same status three ways. Same data, three audiences, three encodings. Write all three into artifacts/18-status-reports.md.	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.
8	Compare a bad status report with a good one. The difference between the two is not length; the good version is shorter. It is that every sentence carries a number, a threshold, a cause, a trend or a decision. Read your own draft sentence by sentence and delete anything that carries none of the five.	Make a group state the UNITS and the base date. Most errors here are unit errors, not maths errors.
9	Answer the exam-style scenarios	Ask what the number would have to be before the decision flips. That is the exam's favourite question.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
8 min	Brief the scenario, confirm the inputs and assign roles
28 min	Work the first half of the steps individually, then pool as a group
28 min	Complete the remaining steps and finalise the deliverable
11 min	Group share-back, facilitator debrief and exam-style linkage

Total: 75 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Compute communication channels with $N(N-1)/2$ and derive the management implication of superlinear growth — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
2. Choose push, pull or interactive communication for each stakeholder and justify the choice — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
3. Place Contoso communications correctly in the formal/informal by written/verbal grid — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
4. Your channel figures are 36 for $N=9$ and 78 for $N=13$, and you stated the +44% versus +117% comparison explicitly — can every member of your group defend it?
5. Where would communication plan, channels and status reporting have saved you time or money on a real project you have worked on?

What good looks like

- Your channel figures are 36 for $N=9$ and 78 for $N=13$, and you stated the +44% versus +117% comparison explicitly.

- You derived a management implication from the formula rather than just computing it. If your notes end at "78 channels", you have done the arithmetic and missed the point.
- Every row of your communication plan has a feedback loop that would let you detect a message failing to land. Rows saying "email sent" have no feedback loop.
- Every Resistant or anxious stakeholder in your plan (S-05, S-06, S-08, S-16) receives an interactive element.
- You computed $CV\% = -22,000 / 249,000 = -8.8\%$ and identified the Lab 03 threshold breach yourself, and your board report states that escalation is mandatory within 5 working days rather than treating it as a judgement call.
- Your three status reports are all traceable to the same four figures - BAC 480,000, PV 268,000, EV 249,000, AC 271,000 - and none of them softens, omits or rounds favourably.
- Your sponsor one-pager contains no acronyms, translates CPI into money, and asks for a specific decision by a specific date.
- Your team report contains blockers and WIP and does not contain EAC. Reporting a forecast at completion to a standup is altitude failure in the other direction.